

Stories Strategy (Stories are Carissa's dominant format)

Last checked: 2026-09-27. This is general practice, not Meta-published rules unless linked.

How Stories and Reels work together

- **Stories reach people who already follow you.** They build trust, drive DMs, link clicks, bookings and market visits. They almost never reach new people.
- **Reels and Trial Reels reach new people.** That's where large view counts come from. New followers then see the Stories.
- So each shoot produces **a Story set (daily) and a Reel cut (most days)** from the same footage. It's one filming session with two outputs.

Building a daily Story set (3–7 frames)

1. **Frame 1 = hook.** Motion plus a bold text line within the first second. People tap past a weak first frame, and that ends the whole set.
2. **Tell it as a mini story:** setup, then the reveal, then a sticker. Leave a cliffhanger ("price reveal on the next slide →") to reduce tap-forwards.
3. **At least one interactive sticker per day:** poll, quiz, slider, question box. These are added in-app, so leave space in the lower-middle third.
4. **Ask for DMs.** "Reply 'MINE' to claim it." "DM me 'DATES' for October openings." Replies tell Instagram people care about your account, which puts your Stories earlier in their tray.
5. **Share each new Reel to Stories** with a "new post" sticker or a teaser crop.
6. **Link sticker** for bookings or shop links, at most once a day. Links reduce story completion.
7. Individual frames: photos 5–7s, videos 5–15s. Anything over 60s gets split.
8. **Highlights:** save best-of sets to profile Highlights (FG: one per property; MBM: "New Finds", "Market Days"; FFF: "Start Here", "Income Reports").

Story metrics to track

Reach, **forward taps and exits on frame 1**, replies, sticker taps, link clicks. A drop-off on frame 1 means the hook needs work.